ROXANA GONZALEZ

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EDUCATION

Expected May 2027 Ph.D. in Economics, University of South Carolina

Dissertation: *Time and Place: Essays on Tax Policy in Housing Markets*
Committee: Dr. Jason DeBacker (chair), Dr. Danna Thomas, Dr. Leah Brooks, Dr. Orgul Ozturk

May 2022 B.A. in Economics, University of Tennessee, *Cum Laude*

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Urban Economics, Public Economics, Real Estate, Artificial Intelligence

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Reassessed & Repossessed: Assessment Shocks and Foreclosure"

Abstract: Most U.S. homes are assessed on mandated cycles of three years or longer. Appreciation goes untaxed between assessments and could translate to a discrete increase in the tax liability after the correction. I study 45 countywide assessments in 34 North Carolina counties between 2011 and 2018, comparing each with counties that assess every year by synthetic difference-in-differences, and observe foreclosures for all homes. An assessment raises the quarterly foreclosure filing rate by 17 percent, about 6,700 additional filings over two years across the assessments studied. The additional filings decline steadily with home value, from 4.3 per 1,000 homes over two years in the cheapest quartile to 1.8 in the most expensive. In 18 reassessments where tax liabilities are also observed, each additional percent of the tax increase raises the completed foreclosure rate by 9 percent of its pre-period level. Long assessment cycles concentrate payment shocks, and the foreclosure filings that follow, on the owners least able to absorb them.

Selected Presentations: American Economic Association Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference (2026); Southern Economic Association Annual Conference (2026); National Tax Association Annual Conference (2026); College of Charleston (2026); Davidson College (2026)

RESEARCH PAPERS

"Opportunity Zones & Housing Supply" [SSRN]
Under review at Regional Science and Urban Economics

Abstract: I study whether the Opportunity Zones (OZ) program, one of the largest place-based development subsidies in U.S. history, generated new housing or merely reallocated development. Using a quarterly panel of residential address counts for all U.S. Census tracts from 2012 to 2025, I document that OZ designation displaced residential development in tracts within ten miles of designated zones. After designation, OZ tracts added 2.2 more housing units per year than comparable distant tracts, while non-OZ tracts

within ten miles added 1.8 fewer, a loss that closely mirrors the gain inside OZ boundaries, consistent with developers relocating projects across tract lines to capture the tax benefit rather than initiating new ones. A net supply test pooling OZs with the displacement region yields no significant gain in housing supply. The results suggest caution in expecting OZ-style capital subsidies to raise aggregate housing production absent complementary zoning or infrastructure reform.

Selected Presentations: American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association International Conference (2026); National Tax Association Annual Conference (2026); American Economic Association Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference (2025); Southern Economic Association Annual Conference (2025)

"What Can LLMs Tell Us About the ETI?" [SSRN], with Jason DeBacker and Max Ghenis

Abstract: This paper investigates the capacity of large language models (LLMs) to approximate the elasticity of taxable income (ETI), a central parameter in public finance. Using simulations of a recent controlled experiment (Pfeil et al., 2024) and replicating a seminal study of observational data (Gruber and Saez, 2002), we evaluate how five popular LLMs respond to tax schedule changes. Our results show that LLMs reproduce key behavioral patterns observed in human studies, though often with heightened responsiveness, suggesting limited recognition of real-world frictions. Findings suggest LLMs' potential as low-cost, flexible complements to traditional methods for analyzing taxpayer behavior and policy design, although further validation across models and contexts is needed.

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Opportunity for Affordability: Tax Incentives and Rental Housing Markets"

Recipient of the Economics Department Best Third-Year Paper Award, 2025

Selected Presentations: American Economic Association Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference (2023)

"The Effectiveness of Local Flavored E-Cigarette Bans", with Kara Jones and Danna Thomas

Selected Presentations: Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Fall Research Conference (2024); American Economic Association Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference (2024)

HONORS, GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2026	Institute for Human Studies Graduate Student Travel Stipend ($500)
2026	NTA Equity and Inclusion Graduate Student Fellowship ($1,500)
2026	SPARC Graduate Research Grant ($5,000), University of South Carolina Office of Research
2026	Graduate School Travel Grant ($800), University of South Carolina Graduate School
2025	Southeastern Annual Economic Conference Graduate Student Award ($1,000)
2025	Melayne Morgan McInnes Memorial Award for Best Third-Year Paper ($1,000), University of South Carolina Moore School of Business

2022	Summer Program Scholar, American Economic Association (AEA)
2018–2022	Pledge Scholar, University of Tennessee

TEACHING POSITIONS

Department of Economics, University of South Carolina Moore School of Business

Instructor of Record

Spring 2026	Introduction to Economics *Overall Instructor Rating: 4.3/5.*

Teaching Assistant

Spring 2026	Professor Lois Miller
Spring 2025	Professor Sang Min Lee
Spring–Fall 2024	Professor Danna Thomas
Fall 2023	Professor Tamara Sheldon

RESEARCH POSTIONS

2025–2026	Research Assistant to Professor Jason DeBacker, University of South Carolina
Summer 2025	Research Assistant to Professor Crystal Zhan, University of South Carolina
Spring 2025	Research Assistant to Professor Jason DeBacker, University of South Carolina
2024	Research Assistant to Professor Danna Thomas, University of South Carolina
Fall 2023	Research Assistant to Professor Crystal Zhan, University of South Carolina
2022–2023	Research Assistant to Professor Jason DeBacker, University of South Carolina
Spring 2022	Research Assistant to Professor Kin Blackburn, University of South Carolina
2021–2022	Research Assistant to Professor Maria Padilla-Romo, University of Tennessee

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Aug. 2025–Aug. 2026	Workforce Data Scientist (part-time), South Carolina Department of Employment and Workforce

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

2026	CSWEP Mentoring Workshop
2026	Institute for Human Studies Job Market Candidate Writing Workshop
2026	Job Market Boot Camp, American Economic Association (AEA) Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference
2025	Summer School in Urban Economics, Urban Economics Association, Tufts University
2024	Applied Data Analytics Training, Coleridge Initiative (confidential micro-data, record linkage, and machine learning)
2022	Summer Training Program, American Economic Association (AEA)

SKILLS

Statistical Software / Programming: Python, SQL, Stata, R
Quantitative Methods: Causal inference, regression, predictive modeling, machine learning
Data Skills: Collection, cleaning, validation, documentation, and dissemination of large datasets
Languages: English (fluent), Spanish (fluent)

SERVICE

First-Generation Graduate Mentor, University of South Carolina, 2024–2025